MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure | Transitioning to DevOps / Platform Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including 2+ years owning CI/CD pipelines and ephemeral Kubernetes test environments for three product teams. Improved average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes, reduced flaky tests from 7% to below 1%, and gained hands-on personal infrastructure experience with Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure and a k3s homelab.

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021 – Present

- Own the GitLab CI pipelines for 3 product teams (~25 developers): build, unit/integration/e2e test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Cut average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies, and separating e2e execution; reduced monthly CI runner cost by approximately 30%.
- Built ephemeral test environments with Docker Compose and Helm on a shared Kubernetes cluster; operated at namespace level while the platform team managed the cluster. Environments enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run e2e tests against isolated environments.
- Maintain the pytest + Playwright e2e suite (~900 tests); flaky rate down from 7% to under 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for test data seeding into PostgreSQL.
- Wrote internal documentation explaining CI workflows; used in onboarding.
- Mentored 2 QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019 – 2021

- Manual and automated testing of web and mobile apps for client projects.
- Introduced Selenium + Java automated regression suite for the biggest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018 – 2019

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases, reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023 – 2024

- Deployed short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments to the shared Kubernetes cluster via Helm from GitLab CI; environments were automatically destroyed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run e2e tests against isolated environments.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results using Python and the GitLab API into PostgreSQL; built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began fixing the top offenders.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal Project | 2024 – 2025

- Ran k3s across three Raspberry Pi 5 nodes, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana, and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a personal Hetzner VPS with Terraform.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Traefik, cert-manager, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

SKILLS

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (personal hands-on experience), Ansible (basic)
Containers and Orchestration: Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level experience on a shared cluster; no cluster administration), k3s
CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Argo CD
Observability: Grafana (test metrics and flaky-test dashboards); Prometheus and Loki (personal project)
Cloud / Hosting: AWS: EC2 and S3 basics through free-tier learning; Hetzner VPS: personal infrastructure provisioned with Terraform
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Languages: Python, Bash, Java (test code)
Databases: PostgreSQL, SQL
Other: Linux, Git

CERTIFICATIONS

ISTQB Foundation Level, 2019

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering, Silesian Lowlands University of Technology, 2018

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)